LGTM at Midnight

Testing in Production

The Coffee is Cold. The Tests are Failing. The Server is Live.

It's 2:47 AM on a Tuesday, and senior software engineer Julian Vance has been awake for 38 straight hours. Fueled entirely by stale energy drinks, extreme paranoia, and a dangerously low sense of self-preservation, Julian is one keystroke away from fixing a minor bug in the company's flagship app.

The message from management: "Skip the staging environment. Push the test code directly to production. We announce the launch in ten minutes."

What follows is an adrenaline-fueled nightmare through a labyrinth of unverified dependencies, commented-out safety checks, and legacy code written by a guy who left the company in 2014 without leaving documentation.

As the push goes live, Julian accidentally grants every user unlimited admin privileges, turns the billing system into a random number generator, and summons a deluge of passive-aggressive Jira tickets.

With the CTO breathing down his neck, Julian has until sunrise to undo the damage—or fake his own internet outage and vanish forever.

L.M. Ctrl is a former IT helpdesk technician turned full-time author who has spent entirely too many hours telling people to "turn it off and on again." When not crafting absurd mystery novels, Ctrl can be found attempting to teach a smart fridge how to keep a secret or arguing with automated customer service bots. This book is their first novel, written entirely on a vintage mechanical keyboard while sipping questionable coffee.

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